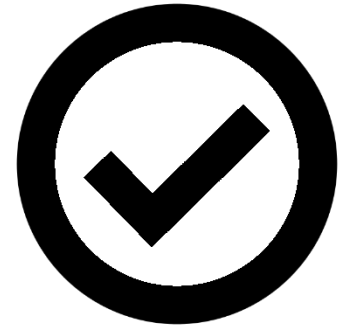


**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



CONTEMPORARY ISSUES (530)

PRELIMINARY

STATE 2021

Description

Demonstrate communication skills in arranging, organizing, and effectively presenting information orally without prior knowledge of the topic.

No materials or previously prepared notes will be allowed into the preparation or presentation room with the contestant.

JUDGING PROCEDURE

- The contestant will draw two (2) different business topics and will select either one. The topics may deal with Business Professionals of America, office situations, the business world, etc.
- The contestant will be provided ten (10) minutes to develop the topic. Notes will be made on the note cards provided by the event proctor. No advisor contact will be allowed between the time of receiving the topic and the delivery.
- Cell phones may not be used in the preparation room.
- Contestants will be introduced by contestant number. **Contestants may continue to wear their name badges.**
- Contestants will present before a panel of judges and timekeeper.
- The length of the speech will be no less three (3) minutes and no more than five (5) minutes.
- The contestant will be given warnings via flash cards when there are two (2) minutes remaining and when there is one (1) minute remaining during the speaking time.
- The speech will be stopped at five (5) minutes.
- No time is allotted for judges' questions.
- Contestants should be dismissed upon completion of their speech.
- **There can be no ties in the top ten (10) contestants.** It is the responsibility of the judges to break any ties.
- Administrator will fill out ranking sheet prior to dismissing the judges.
- If more than one (1) section is necessary, finalists will be determined by selecting an equal number from each section.
- Give administrator all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets, and contest materials.
- No audience is allowed in the contest room.

Please double-check and verify all scores!

TOPICS:

Discuss why employers often check a potential employee's credit history before offering them a position.

Describe a situation where you had to "think outside the box."

The Internet enables individuals to have immediate access to vast quantities of information. What strategies do you use to differentiate between factual and fictional information?

Appearances can often be deceiving. Describe a time when you discovered this to be true.

Many legislators are supporting legislation that would allow students to replace the foreign language requirement with a computer programming course (such as Python). Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of this change.

Discuss a time when your silence resulted in a new perspective on something.